

Two Players Hurt

Miners' Knox Has Streak

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PHOENIX — Two simple plays proved to be the key for Arizona State as they were able to down U.T.-El Paso 5-2 last night.

The two teams played an afternoon game today and the second game of the double-header was set tonight with Miner coach Andy Cohen expected to start junior right-hander Mike Kruta (0-1) on the mound.

Arizona State had scored an unearned run in the first inning via an error by U.T.-El Paso's Herb von Hagen. The Sun Devils loaded the bases in the bottom of the second on an infield grounder.

"(Jeff) Hogan didn't get over to first to cover the bag," remarked Cohen. "Gary Atwell then hit a line drive just over Von Hagen's head and, what should have been a single, got in between Larry McKay and Malcolm McLean and rolled all the way to the wall for an inside-the-park home run."

DESPITE THE mistakes, Cohen was pleased "with the way the boys hung in there to the end and almost pulled the game out."

Miner relief pitcher Bob Knox extended his string of innings without allowing an earned run to 34 2-3 by hurling 6 1-3 frames last night. He was in trouble several times with his control as he walked five and struck out only two.

"His control was not as good as it has been," Cohen added, "but he baffled them the rest of the way."

"ARIZONA State's pitcher Ed Bane was the difference in the game. He is a smart pitcher with good control. He only walked one and struck out 14.

Cohen was worried over the injuries to Ray Greggerson and Barry Alburtis.

"I was planning on starting Greggerson last night, but he stepped on a sprinkler head with his pivot foot at the motel. We have him bandaged up right now and we don't know when he will return. Alburtis rehurt his shoulder while diving for a ground ball in the first inning. We will see on how it heals before we play him again."